



Brand Brief

*The foundational strategic brief for JCE Tree Service. This is the shared source of truth for the brand behind every initiative (website, advertising & media, reviews/reputation, direct mail, and general communications refresh). Project-specific briefs (Website Brief, Advertising & Media Plan Brief, and future ones) build from this. **This document should be used for internal use only.***

1. Company Profile

- Business Name: JCE Tree Service
- Contact Person: Joe Cardin
- Location: River Falls, Wisconsin
- Years in Business: Founded 2001; celebrated 25 years in 2026
- Business Model: Family-owned local service provider, residential + commercial clients
- Team Size: 10-12 employees currently
- www.jcetree.com , [Facebook](#) , [Instagram](#)

2. Business Goals

- Increase # of booked jobs by 6–8 per week
- Defend and strengthen JCE's position as the established market leader in River Falls, as newer competitors enter and compete for local visibility and leads
- Grow brand presence and strengthen visibility in Hudson and Prescott

3. Marketing Goal

- Increase qualified leads by +10–15/week (avg. 40–45/month) from residential homeowners within the target service area seeking tree removal, large tree removal, pruning/trimming, or tree health care

4. Target Audience

- Primary segment: residential homeowners, 45+, established properties with mature trees
- Highest-value segment: established homeowners with larger (often country) properties requiring multiple services. This leads to larger jobs and more repeat business

Need states. These are the distinct situations that put a customer in the market, distinguished by what triggers them and how the customer behaves once triggered.

- **Emergency:** Storm damage, a tree on a structure, or a hazardous leaning/dead tree. High urgency, high intent — the customer calls whoever can respond fastest, with little to no comparison shopping.
- **Planned removal & pruning:** A declining, unwanted, or hazardous tree (ex.: an ash tree in decline). High intent — the work has already been decided on — but lower urgency, so the customer typically gathers and compares a few estimates before choosing.
- **Ongoing health & maintenance:** Surfaces seasonally or through an existing service relationship, rather than independent research. Typically discussed during or after another job, or on a recurring basis. A different discovery path than the other two.

5. Service Area & Market Focus

- **Core services, priority order:** Tree Removal, Tree Pruning, Emergency Services, Plant Health Care, Tree Inspection, Lot & Land Clearing, Brush Clean Up, Brush Mowing, Stump Grinding
- **Lead-gen priority:** Large tree removals first, tree removals, ash tree removals, pruning/trimming, then emergency work (tree on roof, fallen tree)
- **Unwanted leads:** Out-of-area inquiries, standalone stump grinding
- **Mix of business (Joe provided, 2026, internal):** ~85%+ residential / remainder commercial. Of total volume, ~65% is removal work.
- **Geographic reach:**
 - Primary: River Falls, Hudson, Prescott
 - Secondary: Ellsworth, Beldenville, Roberts, Houlton, Hammond, Baldwin, New Richmond, Spring Valley, Hastings, Afton, Lake St. Croix Beach, Lakeland
- **Primary competitors:** SavATree, NWI Tree Care, Trailblazers.
- **Secondary:** Willow River Company, Bundy Logging and Tree Service
- A full competitive analysis is available in the Brand Central Drive.

6. Positioning & Differentiators

Client-stated differentiators versus competitors:

- Four certified arborist on staff, plus two team members with forestry degrees
- Four licensed pesticide applicators on staff
- 25 years of local experience
- Advanced equipment for large, complex jobs
- Meticulous property protection and cleanup

Core customer benefit

- Functional: expert care for their trees and yard, easy process from estimate through cleanup
- Emotional: peace of mind, trust that the job is in capable hands

JCE Tree Service Positioning Statement (THIS IS NOT CUSTOMER FACING LANGUAGE, THIS IS THE POSITION WE BUILD THAT LANGUAGE FROM)

For homeowners across the St. Croix River Valley, anchored in River Falls, Hudson, and Prescott, who do not want to gamble on who shows up to do the job or what their yard looks like afterward, JCE Tree Service is the tree care company homeowners in the community already trust to deliver local expertise, the right equipment, and the same high quality service on every job, no exceptions

Reasons to Believe (this is the proof behind the position)

- **Earned Trust.** More local homeowners recommend JCE than any other tree service
- **Local Expertise.** Our team includes four ISA certified arborists, two members with forestry degrees, four licensed pesticide applicators, and an owner with decades of hands-on experience caring for trees in the community.
- **Proven Consistency.** More than 8 out of 10 JCE customers call us again. That is what happens when a job is done right the first time.
- **The Right Equipment.** JCE invests in a full range of equipment, each piece chosen to protect the lawn and property while getting the job done right.
- **Personal Straightforward Estimates.** An arborist, usually Joe himself, visits every property, hand-writes the estimate, and talks homeowners through it in person or by phone when needed.

Unique Selling Propositions

- The only Tree Service in the St. Croix River Valley built on 25 years of local homeowner trust and word of mouth recommendations
- An arborist, usually Joe himself, visits every property, completes a tree diagnosis, hand-writes the estimate, and walks homeowners through it in person or by phone, so they understand exactly what they need and why before agreeing to anything.
- The only crew in the area combining four ISA certified arborists, forestry degree holders, and licensed pesticide applicators, and an owner with decades of hands-on local experience.
- An expert crew and equipment on every job, providing professional service and meticulous cleanup, proven by an 80 percent plus repeat customer rate.
- The only tree service in the area where every piece of equipment is chosen to protect the lawn and property.

7. Tone & Voice

JCE's voice is grounded in who Joe actually is: funny, humble, kind, and a common-sense local guy built on hard work, follow-through, and an obsession with quality. That personality comes through in three voice traits.

Expert, not stuffy. We know trees, and we talk like it. But we never talk over anyone's head. We talk like professionals who clearly know what they're doing, explaining it in a way any homeowner can follow.

Warm, with a little humor. We don't take ourselves too seriously, even when the work is serious. A little personality is welcome. A joke, a dry, understated line here or there, or a moment of levity can go a long way, especially on planned work and everyday conversations, like "people think anyone with a chainsaw can cut down a tree," or "I get calls from homeowners are surprised when two guys in a truck show up to do the job and take three days to do it."

When talking about emergencies (a tree down on the house, storm damage, anything urgent), the tone shifts a bit to more calm, direct, and reassuring.

Personal and local. This is not a large corporation. It's the JCE crew, in Joe and Ross' home community. Write as a local. Name the towns specifically (River Falls, Hudson, Prescott) rather than "our service area" or the "St Croix River Valley" whenever possible, and talk about things in the community: the streets, the buildings you're working on, tree disease that's affecting the area, tree care that is seasonally relevant, town happenings like participating in the parade and local fundraisers.

8. Communication Pillars (EXTERNAL LANGUAGE we say the the things in the first 3 columns, the last two are for context only)

Translates the internal Positioning Statement into the external message themes used across every channel: website, paid ads, mailers, and in-person/phone conversations. Each pillar pairs a homeowner-facing promise with the Reason to Believe (RTB) and USP proof behind it, so the same claims show up consistently no matter the format. The Voice & Tone section below sets how all of it should sound.

Pillar	Promise	Proof	Why it matters	How we will use it
The Highest Standard of Tree Care, No Exceptions	The highest quality standard, on every property, every time: the professional crew, the equipment, and the result you were	4.9 star rating 8+ out of 10 JCE customers call again Add testimonials	Property damage is a worry homeowners often already have going in. Who actually shows up to do the work isn't something they think to worry about ahead of time, but when the crew turns out	Hero messaging, taglines, and any headline territory. This is the pillar the other two exist to back up.

Pillar	Promise	Proof	Why it matters	How we will use it
	promised during your estimate, no exceptions.		to be unprofessional, it lands as an unpleasant surprise. Naming the standard up front, before that surprise has a chance to happen, is a differentiator versus newer, less-established competitors who can't make this claim as credibly yet.	
Trusted & Credentialed Arborists and Plant Health Professionals	More homeowners recommend JCE than any other tree service in River Falls, and every job is led by credentialed local arborists and tree professionals, not a crew from out of town that works in our community occasionally, or a startup crew with a chainsaw and a truck.	25 years of local homeowner trust and word-of-mouth recommendations. Four ISA-certified arborists, two team members with forestry degrees, four licensed pesticide applicators, and an owner with decades of hands-on local experience.	Word of mouth is the highest-trust signal in a category where homeowners worry about getting oversold, and it's the hardest thing for a newer competitor to fake. Framing JCE as a credentialed team that lives here, rather than an outside crew or a newer startup, works against both kinds of emerging competitors at once.	Review call-outs, "your neighbors already trust us" mailer and social territory, and local-market-leader framing against newer entrants. About/credentials content, diagnosis-first messaging on health and pruning services, and anywhere a credential can be paired with "which means..." rather than left as a list.
The Personal Estimate	An arborist, usually Joe himself, comes to your property, inspects your trees, hand-writes your estimate, and walks you through it, so you know exactly what you need and why before agreeing to anything.	Every estimate is a personal property visit and a hand-written document, walked through in person or by phone.	Directly defuses the "am I being upsold" fear that shadows most home-service purchases, and puts local expert behind the company rather than an inexperienced sales rep.	Contact/estimate CTAs, the "what happens after I reach out" content homeowners look for, anything establishing Joe as the face of the company.
Property-First Care	We treat your yard like it's ours.	A full range of equipment, each piece chosen specifically to protect the lawn and property, paired with	"Will they wreck my lawn or driveway" is one of the top fears homeowners have about tree work, right behind safety.	Removal and emergency service content especially, before/after or process photography, any copy addressing

Pillar	Promise	Proof	Why it matters	How we will use it
		meticulous cleanup on every job.		property-damage anxiety.

9. Success Measures

- Qualified leads generated
- Cost per qualified lead